Ansible Automation - Use Cases

A reference of the use cases by which Ansible Automation Platform is commonly implemented, by domain. Each use case is described in the same format (Description, Collection, Key content, Notes) and mapped to Red Hat Certified and Validated content.

6 solution use cases · 3 product use cases · generated 2026-10-21 · community reference, not an official Red Hat publication

Contents

1. ITSM & CMDB
    - Solution use cases (6)
        - Create and update ServiceNow incidents from automation
        - Automate change requests with approval gates
        - Fulfil service catalog requests with Automation Platform
        - Sync the CMDB from automation facts
        - Use ServiceNow CMDB as inventory
        - Orchestrate approvals, surveys and notifications in workflows
    - Product use cases
        - ServiceNow (3)

ITSM & CMDB

Ticket-driven automation, change management and CMDB synchronisation.

Solution use cases

Use Case: Create and update ServiceNow incidents from automation

Description	Operations teams want every automated fix to be visible in the ticketing system. Playbooks open an incident when a job fails or a problem is detected, add work notes and attachments while the work runs, and resolve the incident when the fix is verified.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified), `ansible.controller` (Certified), `manageengine.sdp_cloud` (Certified)
Key content	• `servicenow.itsm.incident` — Manage ServiceNow incidents • `servicenow.itsm.incident_info` — List ServiceNow incidents • `servicenow.itsm.problem` — Manage ServiceNow problems • `servicenow.itsm.attachment_upload` — Upload attachment to the selected table • `servicenow.itsm.api` — Manage ServiceNow POST, PATCH and DELETE requests • `ansible.controller.notification_template` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller notification.
Notes	• Pair with Build self-healing infrastructure from monitoring alerts so alerts create the incident and the fix closes it. The `servicenow.itsm.records` event source can also start automation when an incident is assigned or updated. • For approval-gated changes use Automate change requests with approval gates. • ManageEngine ServiceDesk Plus Cloud users can use the `manageengine.sdp_cloud` collection for the same pattern. • Store the ServiceNow password as a credential, never in the playbook or inventory.

Use Case: Automate change requests with approval gates

Description	Standard and normal changes follow a fixed process: request, approval, implementation, review. Automation Platform runs the implementation, and ServiceNow stays the system of record. The change record is created from the playbook, the job waits until the change is approved, and the result is written back to the change.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified), `ansible.controller` (Certified)
Key content	• `servicenow.itsm.change_request` — Manage ServiceNow change requests • `servicenow.itsm.change_request_info` — List ServiceNow change requests • `servicenow.itsm.change_request_task` — Manage ServiceNow change request tasks • `ansible.controller.workflow_job_template` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller workflow job templates. • `ansible.controller.workflow_approval` — Approve an approval node in a workflow job.

Notes	• Combine with Orchestrate approvals, surveys and notifications in workflows for the workflow mechanics. • Emergency changes can skip the wait node but should still create and close a change record. • Patching, configuration and cloud use cases elsewhere on this site can be dropped in as the implementation node.

Use Case: Fulfil service catalog requests with Automation Platform

Description	Users order standard services, such as a virtual machine, a database or an access change, from the ServiceNow catalog. Automation Platform fulfils the request unattended and updates the request tasks, so the requester sees progress and the ticket closes without manual hand-offs.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified), `ansible.controller` (Certified)
Key content	• `servicenow.itsm.service_catalog_info` — List ServiceNow service catalogs along with categories and items • `servicenow.itsm.service_catalog` — Manage ServiceNow service catalog cart • `servicenow.itsm.catalog_request` — Manage ServiceNow catalog requests • `servicenow.itsm.catalog_request_info` — List ServiceNow catalog requests • `servicenow.itsm.catalog_request_task` — Manage ServiceNow catalog request tasks • `ansible.controller.job_template` — create, update, or destroy job templates.
Notes	• Related: Create and update ServiceNow incidents from automation for failures. • Use the provisioning use cases for the target platform (VMware, AWS, Azure, OpenShift Virtualization) as the fulfilment job. • Keep one catalog item per outcome. Free-form requests are hard to automate.

Use Case: Sync the CMDB from automation facts

Description	Automation already gathers accurate facts from servers, devices and applications. Writing those facts to the ServiceNow CMDB keeps configuration items current without a separate discovery tool, and keeps relations such as "application runs on server" correct after builds and changes.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified), `ansible.controller` (Certified)
Key content	• `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item` — Manage ServiceNow configuration items • `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item_batch` — Manage ServiceNow configuration items in batch mode • `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item_info` — List ServiceNow configuration item • `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item_relations` — Manage ServiceNow relations between configuration items • `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item_relations_info` — Retreive ServiceNow relations of configuration items • `ansible.controller.schedule` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller schedules.

Notes	• Pair with Use ServiceNow CMDB as inventory to close the loop in both directions. • Agree on a single source of truth per attribute to avoid automation and discovery tools overwriting each other.

Use Case: Use ServiceNow CMDB as inventory

Description	Instead of keeping a second list of hosts, the inventory is built from the ServiceNow CMDB. Servers, network devices and applications that are registered and active in the CMDB become inventory hosts, grouped by class, environment or support group.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified), `ansible.controller` (Certified)
Key content	• `servicenow.itsm.now` — Inventory source for ServiceNow table records. • `servicenow.itsm.configuration_item_info` — List ServiceNow configuration item • `ansible.controller.inventory_source` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller inventory source. • `ansible.controller.inventory_source_update` — Update inventory source(s).
Notes	• Data quality is the main risk: hosts without a resolvable name fail at connection time. Add a validation job that lists unreachable CMDB items. • Pair with Sync the CMDB from automation facts so facts flow back to the CMDB. • Other inventory sources such as Satellite, VMware and cloud providers are covered in the platform use cases.

Use Case: Orchestrate approvals, surveys and notifications in workflows

Description	Multi-step processes, such as building a server or opening access, need inputs from a person, an approval from a manager and a message when they finish. Automation Platform workflows join several job templates with logic for success, failure and always paths, with the human steps built in.
Collection	`ansible.controller` (Certified), `servicenow.itsm` (Certified)
Key content	• `ansible.controller.workflow_job_template` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller workflow job templates. • `ansible.controller.workflow_job_template_node` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller workflow job template nodes. • `ansible.controller.workflow_approval` — Approve an approval node in a workflow job. • `ansible.controller.notification_template` — create, update, or destroy Automation Platform Controller notification. • `ansible.controller.job_template` — create, update, or destroy job templates. • `servicenow.itsm.incident` — Manage ServiceNow incidents
Notes	• Used as the foundation for Automate change requests with approval gates and Fulfil service catalog requests with Automation Platform. • For application stacks see Shut down and start up a multi-tier application. • Event-Driven Ansible can start the same workflow from an alert, see Build self-healing infrastructure from monitoring alerts.

Product use cases

Grouped from the modules of each certified or validated collection. Key content lists the components each use case supports, with the modules that manage them (create, update, delete) and query them (_info).

ServiceNow `servicenow.itsm`

Certified Red Hat · version 2.16.0 · updated 2026-08-24 · 25 modules → 3 use cases

Use Case: Manage incidents, problems and changes

Description	Create, update and close incidents, problems, change requests and their tasks.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified, Red Hat)
Key content	**Incidents** `incident`, `incident_info` **Problems** `problem`, `problem_info` **Problem tasks** `problem_task`, `problem_task_info` **Change requests** `change_request`, `change_request_info` **Change request tasks** `change_request_task`, `change_request_task_info`

Use Case: Manage requests and the configuration database

Description	Manage service catalog carts, catalog requests and tasks, and configuration items and their relations.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified, Red Hat)
Key content	**Service catalog carts** `service_catalog`, `service_catalog_info` **Catalog requests** `catalog_request`, `catalog_request_info` **Catalog request tasks** `catalog_request_task`, `catalog_request_task_info` **Configuration items** `configuration_item`, `configuration_item_info` **Configuration items in batch** `configuration_item_batch` **Configuration item relations** `configuration_item_relations`, `configuration_item_relations_info`

Use Case: Integrate ServiceNow with Ansible

Description	Call the ServiceNow API, handle attachments, build inventory from table records and trigger Event-Driven Ansible from record changes.
Collection	`servicenow.itsm` (Certified, Red Hat)
Key content	**ServiceNow API requests** `api`, `api_info` **Attachment download** `attachment_info` **Attachment upload** `attachment_upload` **Table record inventory** inventory `now` **Record events** eda event source `records`

Other certified and validated collections

Module-level content for these collections could not be read from a public source repository. Browse them on Automation Hub.

`manageengine.sdp_cloud`	Ansible Collection for interacting with ManageEngine ServiceDeskPlus Cloud ITSM (Certified, ManageEngine)